

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

H O O K

Start here

1

The part of a coat that covers your head

2

The opposite of bad

3

A shiny yellow metal

4

A game where you hit a ball into holes

W O L F

Finish here

Ladder 2

S A I D

Start here

1

Cloth on a boat that catches the wind

2

A happy dog wags it

3

The opposite of short

4

One side of a room

W I L L

Finish here

Ladder 3

L A M B

Start here

1

It gives light on a table or desk

2

To sleep outside in a tent

3

The dog ____ when I called it.

4

A big hole in the side of a hill

W A V E

Finish here

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

H O O K

Start here

1 H O O D

The part of a coat that covers your head

2 G O O D

The opposite of bad

3 G O L D

A shiny yellow metal

4 G O L F

A game where you hit a ball into holes

W O L F

Finish here

Ladder 2

S A I D

Start here

1 S A I L

Cloth on a boat that catches the wind

2 T A I L

A happy dog wags it

3 T A L L

The opposite of short

4 W A L L

One side of a room

W I L L

Finish here

Ladder 3

L A M B

Start here

1 L A M P

It gives light on a table or desk

2 C A M P

To sleep outside in a tent

3 C A M E

The dog ____ when I called it.

4 C A V E

A big hole in the side of a hill

W A V E

Finish here